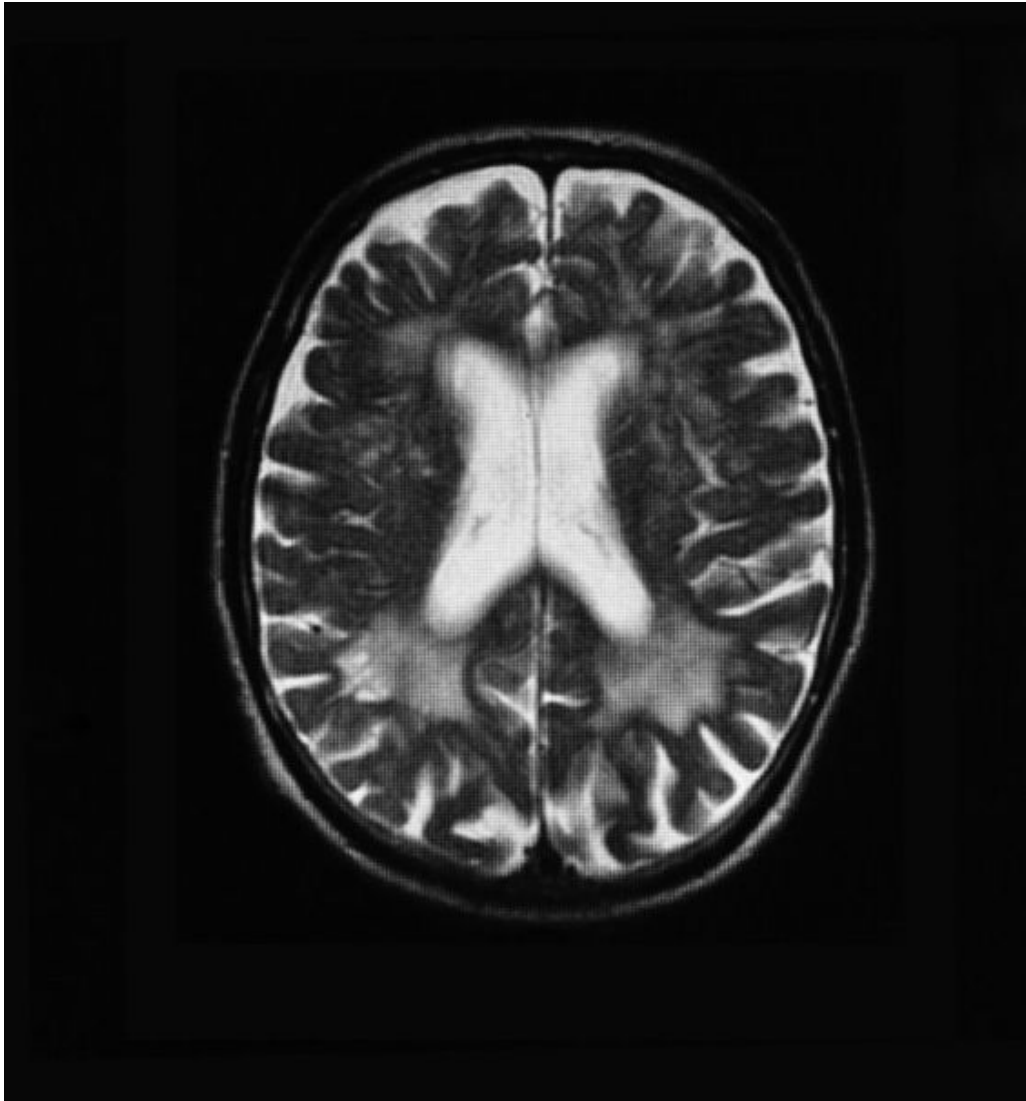


Philosophy and science in the 20th century



Neuroscience can tell us more about the way our brains work than introspective philosophy.

Most of the sciences evolved from branches of philosophy, complementing them with scientific theories describing the physical world. But as the pace of progress accelerated with the scientific revolution of the Enlightenment, the natural sciences largely replaced metaphysics, and by the end of the 19th century psychology and neuroscience began to provide a scientific alternative to the philosophy of the mind. In the 20th century, Albert Einstein's theories seemed to provide a comprehensive explanation of the physical universe, but many aspects of the new physics threw up almost as

many questions as answers – problems that science alone could not explain. And just as science appeared to be replacing aspects of philosophy, some philosophers turned their attention to science itself. Karl Popper proposed a practical answer to the problem of induction (see [The problem of induction](#)), the basis of scientific methods, while Paul Feyerabend questioned the notion of a single reliable scientific method, based on Thomas Kuhn's idea that science makes advances not in a smooth progression, but in a radical jumps.